予 想 問 題　第 2 回

前 期 日 程　対 策

英 語 問 題

東北大学（全学部共通）の出題形式に準拠 ／ 問題

注　意

1. 問題部分と解答用紙で構成されている（問題部分 1〜10ページ・解答用紙 11〜12ページ）。答えは解答用紙の決められた欄に書くこと。
2. 試験時間の目安は100分。大問はⅠ〜Ⅳの4題。
3. 配点は Ⅰ 60点・Ⅱ 50点・Ⅲ 40点・Ⅳ 50点（計200点）。本予想問題が独自に定めた配点である。
4. 本冊子の英文・日本文・設問はすべてオリジナルである。登場する人物・団体・地名は架空。

東北大学の過去問・公式問題ではありません。予想問題であり，大学とは関係がありません。
本冊子は過去の出題形式を分析して作成した練習用の教材です。

I 長文読解（配点 60点）

以下の英文を読み，後の問いに答えなさい。

Anyone who has walked through a large city carrying a heavy bag, pushing a stroller or nursing a sore knee knows how much a place to sit can matter. A bench in the shade, a low wall beside a fountain, or a few broad steps outside a library (ア)can turn an exhausting errand into a manageable one. Yet public seating is rarely discussed as seriously as roads, railways or housing. Seating is usually treated as a minor decoration, something added once a project is nearly finished if money happens to remain. In recent decades, moreover, many cities have quietly reduced the number of places where people can sit without paying, removing benches from stations, squares and shopping streets.

The reasons usually given are practical. Benches need cleaning and repair, and some officials argue that they (イ)attract people who stay for hours, which shop owners fear may discourage customers. In some places, seats have been replaced by narrow ledges that slope forward, or by benches divided by metal armrests (ウ)so that no one can lie down. In others, the number of benches (エ)have simply fallen year by year, often without any public announcement. Designs of this kind are sometimes described as “defensive,” because their purpose is (オ)less to welcome some users than to keep others away. (1)This has led critics to ask whom public space is really meant to serve, and whether a city that makes resting difficult is quietly telling some of its residents that they do not belong.

The question matters because the people who depend most on public seating are often those with the least choice. An older person (カ)who cannot walk far without resting may simply stay at home if there is nowhere to pause on the way to the shops. A parent with a tired child, a worker on a short break, a student waiting for a late bus — all of them benefit from a free place to sit, and few of them can afford (キ)buying a drink in a café every time they need a rest. For people who are ill or recovering from an injury, a single bench at the right spot can decide whether a short trip is possible at all. Removing seating, then, does not affect everyone equally; it shifts the burden onto those least able to carry it.

Shop owners’ fears are understandable, since no one wants a doorway blocked or customers made uncomfortable. (Ⅰ), there is reason to doubt that taking seats away is good for business. People who can rest are able to stay in a shopping street longer, and it seems reasonable to expect that visitors who stay longer will look into more shops. Someone who must leave because their feet hurt, by contrast, spends nothing more at all. A street (ク)that offers nowhere to sit may look tidy, but it also gives visitors one more reason to shop online or drive to

a large mall where seating is provided as standard. In this sense, a few benches may rank among the cheapest investments a shopping street can make.

Seating has a social value as well. A bench is among the few places in a city where strangers sit side by side (ケ)without having arranged to meet. Conversations start there about the weather, a passing dog or a delayed train, and regular users come to recognize one another over time. (2)For people who live alone, these brief exchanges may be the only contact with others they have in a whole day, and their importance is easy to overlook precisely because they look so ordinary. A city that removes such places saves a little money on maintenance but may pay for it in loneliness that never appears in any budget.

None of this means that the concerns behind defensive design are imaginary. Benches can be misused, and the people who manage public spaces have to respond to complaints. The difference lies in the response. One approach tries to solve problems by making seats uncomfortable for everyone. Another tries to make seating more welcoming while dealing with specific problems directly — by cleaning more often, by improving lighting, or by working with social services to support people who have nowhere else to go. Clear rules about use, explained politely on signs, can address many complaints without punishing everyone else. Planners who follow this second approach tend to provide seats with backs, place them in the shade and at regular intervals along busy routes, and add arms at each end that (コ)help older people stand up again.

Such choices may seem small, but they reflect a view of the city as a shared home rather than merely a space for passing through and buying things. When seats are plentiful, a square becomes somewhere to spend time, not just somewhere to cross. Children play nearby while adults watch, older residents rest before continuing their walk, and the public life of the street becomes visible. Benches also allow people to enjoy a view, read in the open air or simply watch the world go by, activities that cost nothing and yet make a neighbourhood feel more alive. It is no accident that the places people describe most warmly in their own towns are often those where it is easy to stop.

The simplest test of a public space may therefore be (3)[(A) tired (B) can (C) whether (D) there (E) person (F) who (G) rest (H) a (I) is] without buying anything. A city that passes this test is not necessarily richer or more beautiful than one that fails it, but it is likely to be kinder, and its streets will be used by a wider range of people. Bringing back the humble bench will not solve every urban problem. It is, however, a cheap and visible way of telling everyone that they are welcome to stay.

*stroller ベビーカー
*ledge （壁から張り出した）細い台

*armrest　ひじ掛け

問 1　文頭の This が指す内容を明らかにしながら，下線部(1)を和訳せよ。

問 2　下線部(2)の意味するところを，本文の内容に沿って日本語で説明せよ。

問 3　空所[I]を補うのに最適な語句を(A)〜(D)のうちから一つ選び，その記号を書け。

(A) Consequently
(B) Nonetheless
(C) Similarly
(D) In other words

問 4　次の表は，第6段落で述べられている二つの考え方をまとめたものである。空所（あ）〜（う）を補うのに最適なものを(A)〜(F)のうちからそれぞれ一つ選び，その記号を書け。

	Defensive design	**Welcoming design**
Main aim	［ あ ］	to let anyone rest for a while
Typical features	narrow sloping ledges; benches divided by metal armrests	［ い ］
How problems are handled	［ う ］	by cleaning, better lighting and help from social services

(A) to keep certain users away
(B) to collect fees from visitors
(C) seats with backs, placed in the shade, with arms at each end
(D) by making seats uncomfortable for everyone
(E) by building more cafés nearby
(F) metal fences around every square

問 5　下線部(ア)〜(オ)と(カ)〜(コ)には，文法的に正しくない箇所がそれぞれ一つずつ含まれている。該当する記号を書け。

問 6　下線部(3)の［　］内の語を正しく並べて意味の通る英文にするとき，3番目・5番目・8番目にくる語の記号を書け。各語は一度ずつ用いること。

問 7　本文の内容と合うものを(A)〜(E)のうちから二つ選び，その記号を書け。

(A) Defensive designs are intended mainly to make public seating more comfortable for all users.

(B) The writer suggests that removing benches places the heaviest burden on people who already have few options.

(C) The passage claims that visitors who cannot sit down are likely to spend more money in nearby shops.

(D) The writer argues that short conversations on benches can matter a great deal to people living alone.

(E) The writer believes that bringing back benches would solve most of the problems that cities face.

II 長文読解（配点 50点）

以下の英文を読み，後の問いに答えなさい。

On a cold evening in late autumn, cinemas fill with people who have paid good money to be frightened. Many of them will spend much of the film with their hands half over their eyes, holding tightly to the arm of the seat, and yet they will walk out into the night smiling and talking excitedly about the scenes that scared them most. Haunted houses at fairgrounds, ghost stories told in the dark, and rides that drop riders from a great height all attract eager crowds. (1)At first sight this seems a strange way to spend free time, for fear is, after all, the emotion that evolved to keep us away from danger, not to draw us toward it.

To understand the puzzle, it helps to recall what fear does to the body. When we sense a threat, the heart beats faster, breathing quickens, muscles tighten and attention narrows to the source of danger. Stress-related chemicals are released into the blood, and for a brief period we may feel stronger and more alert than usual. These changes prepare us to fight or to run, and in a genuine emergency they can save a life. In ordinary circumstances, however, the same reactions feel (a)distressing: a racing heart and shaking hands are not what most people would choose to experience on a quiet afternoon. Few of us, after all, would describe a real accident or a sudden illness as entertaining, and nobody buys a ticket to be robbed.

The key difference seems to be safety. While we watch a frightening film, the body reacts as though the threat were real, but the mind knows perfectly well that the monster on the screen cannot climb out of it. We experience the physical excitement of danger without its actual consequences. When the film ends, the alarm switches off, and what remains is a powerful sense of (b)relief, often mixed with a small feeling of pride at having endured it. In the end, (2) [(A) nothing (B) is (C) hurt (D) the (E) it (F) that (G) us (H) knowledge (I) really (J) can] that turns fear into fun. Remove that knowledge, and the same racing heart would feel like nothing but terror.

A related explanation concerns control. People who enter a haunted house at a fair choose to go in, and they know that the door at the far end will open within a few minutes. The rider on a roller coaster understands that the ride, however wild, will be over before long. Even the scream that riders let out on the steepest drop is partly a performance, a way of joining in rather than a cry for help. Real fears are quite different. The worry that comes with losing a job or waiting to hear how a medical test turned out is not something we chose, and we cannot simply decide to end it. Frightening entertainment offers fear with a clear beginning and a clear end, and that boundary may be exactly what allows people to relax inside it.

Being scared has a social side as well. Friends who watch a horror film together grab one another's arms, scream at the same moments and laugh at themselves afterwards. Teenagers at a sleepover compete to tell the most chilling story, and the listeners huddle closer as the tale goes on. Such moments can strengthen friendships as calmer activities rarely do, because those frightened together feel that they have shared something real. Years later, the same friends may still laugh about the night they all refused to walk home alone after a particularly frightening film. (3)Fear shared is, in a sense, fear halved, and the laughter that follows a scream is a way of telling one another that the danger is over.

Some thinkers have suggested that frightening stories may also serve as a kind of rehearsal. Traditional tales for children are full of hungry wolves, wicked witches and dark forests, and they have been told for generations even though they can keep a young listener awake at night. One possible reason is that such stories allow children to meet danger in a form they can manage. A child who hears how a clever girl escapes from a wolf learns, in a small way, that threats can be faced and overcome. The fear is real enough to be felt, but the story keeps it within limits that a child can handle. Adults reading such tales aloud often soften the most frightening parts or pause to reassure a worried listener, adjusting the level of fear to suit the child.

Not everyone, of course, enjoys being frightened, and treating those who dislike horror films as simply less brave than others would be a mistake. (4)People for whom frightening entertainment brings no pleasure may find that the fear stays with them long after the film has ended, returning when they turn off the light or walk down a dark street. For some, imagined dangers feel uncomfortably close to things they have actually experienced, so that what others see as play feels to them like a reminder of real pain. Others simply find that their bodies take a long time to calm down. For such people, the line between pretend danger and real distress is too (c)thin to be comfortable, and avoiding scary films is a sensible choice rather than a weakness.

This variety points to an important truth about frightening entertainment: it works only within limits. When the line between pretend and real disappears, fear stops being fun and becomes what it was originally meant to be, a warning. Yet the fact that so many people can enjoy it at all says something remarkable about human beings. We can borrow an emotion that developed to help our ancestors survive and use it for play, to share it with friends and even to draw lessons from it. Seen in this light, a crowd leaving a cinema with pounding hearts is not behaving strangely at all. It is simply showing how (d)flexible our emotions can be.

*fairground　移動遊園地
*sleepover　友人宅でのお泊まり会

*huddle　身を寄せ合う
*rehearsal　予行演習

問 1　下線部(1)を和訳せよ。

問 2　下線部(2)の［　］内の語を正しく並べて意味の通る英文にするとき，3番目・6番目・9番目にくる語の記号を書け。各語は一度ずつ用いること。

問 3　下線部(3)が具体的に表している内容を，本文に沿って日本語で説明せよ。

問 4　下線部(4)の人々の説明として，本文と合致しないものを(A)〜(D)のうちから一つ選び，その記号を書け。

(A) They may keep feeling afraid long after the film has finished.
(B) Imagined dangers may remind them of painful things that really happened to them.
(C) They lack the courage that people who enjoy horror films have.
(D) Their bodies may need a long time to become calm again.

問 5　本文の内容と合うものを(A)〜(E)のうちから二つ選び，その記号を書け。

(A) The writer regards fear as an emotion that originally developed to protect people from danger.
(B) People enjoy frightening films because their bodies hardly react to what appears on the screen.
(C) Knowing that a frightening experience will end soon can make it easier to enjoy.
(D) Anyone who avoids horror films is described in the passage as lacking courage.
(E) The writer insists that traditional tales should no longer include wolves and witches.

問 6　下線部(a)〜(d)の文脈上の意味に最も近い語句を，それぞれ(A)〜(D)のうちから一つ選び，その記号を書け。

(a) distressing	(A) upsetting	(B) refreshing	(C) boring	(D) surprising
(b) relief	(A) regret	(B) confusion	(C) ease after worry	(D) fresh fear
(c) thin	(A) wide	(B) narrow	(C) clear	(D) heavy
(d) flexible	(A) fragile	(B) predictable	(C) dangerous	(D) adaptable

III　会話文・意見論述（配点 40点）

Professor Thornbury teaches a course on education and society. When a class finishes, she asks two students, Haruto and Leila, what they think about a plan being discussed at another university. Go through their conversation and then deal with tasks 1) and 2) that follow it.

Professor Thornbury: Before you go, I'd like your reactions to something. A university I visited recently is considering a rule that every student must complete sixty hours of community volunteering before graduating. The idea has caused quite a stir among staff and students there, so I'm curious what you two make of it.

Haruto: I think it's a great idea. When I was in high school, I helped out at a food bank for a few months, and it completely changed how I saw my own town. I met people I would never have spoken to otherwise. If it hadn't been a school project, though, I probably wouldn't have gone at all, so I think a little push can be useful.

Professor Thornbury: That's a point supporters often make: people don't always know what they'll enjoy until they try it. They also argue that students benefit from practical experience. Employers frequently say they want graduates who can work in teams and communicate with many different people, and volunteering can help to (1)cultivate those abilities. Leila, you're frowning.

Leila: Sorry, I'm not against volunteering at all. I just don't see how it can still be called volunteering if it's compulsory. The whole point is that you choose to give your time. If students are forced to do it, some will just turn up, sign the form and leave. I'm not sure that helps anyone, least of all the organizations that have to supervise them.

Professor Thornbury: That's a fair concern. Some charities have said exactly that: they welcome help, but training reluctant volunteers takes staff time they can't always spare. Haruto, what would you say to that?

Haruto: Maybe the university could let students choose among various activities, so that each person finds something they actually care about. Someone who loves sports could coach children, and someone interested in the environment could help clean up a river. If people have a choice, they're more likely to take it seriously.

Leila: Choice would help, but there's another problem. Many students already have part-time jobs to pay their rent and fees. I work three evenings a week at a restaurant. Sixty extra hours might not sound like much, but for some of us it would mean losing income or sleep. Students from wealthier families could easily find the time, so the rule would fall (2)disproportionately on those who are already struggling.

Professor Thornbury: That's an important point about fairness. Some universities have tried to deal with it by counting certain kinds of paid work in the community, or by spreading the hours over four years. Others offer small grants to cover travel costs. The details make a big difference to who benefits and who pays.

Haruto: Students who work never crossed my mind. I suppose a rule that looks fair on paper might not be fair in practice.

Leila: Exactly. And I worry that it could turn something generous into just another box to tick on the way to a degree.

Professor Thornbury: Then again, you could argue that many valuable things in education are compulsory. Nobody chooses to take every required course, and yet some of those courses turn out to be the ones students remember most. Requirements can open doors that people wouldn't have opened themselves. The question is whether volunteering is an activity that survives being required, or whether the requirement (3)undermines the very motivation it hopes to build.

Leila: So it depends on how the rule is designed, not just on whether it exists.

Professor Thornbury: Precisely. Rules are rarely good or bad in themselves; their effects depend on the details and on the people they apply to. That would make an excellent topic for your end-of-term essays, by the way. I'll put some readings on the course page, including a report from a university that has had a similar requirement for several years, and you can judge the (4)outcome for yourselves.

1)

For each underlined expression (1)–(4), pick the option from (A)–(D) closest to its meaning in this conversation.

(1) cultivate	(A) hide	(B) measure	(C) develop	(D) replace
(2) disproportionately	(A) more heavily than is fair	(B) more slowly than expected	(C) in a hidden way	(D) in equal amounts
(3) undermines	(A) strengthens	(B) explains	(C) weakens	(D) announces
(4) outcome	(A) cost	(B) result	(C) reason	(D) rule

2)

Should universities require every student to do community volunteering before graduating? Give your opinion with two supporting reasons, using between 60 and 80 English words.

Ⅳ　日本文の英訳・語句整序（配点 50点）

以下の日本文を読み，後の問いに答えなさい。

自分にはどんな仕事が向いているのか，何を学べばよいのかと，机の前で長い時間考え込んでしまう若い人は多い。考えること自体は悪いことではない。(1)しかし，何が自分に合っているかは，頭の中で考えているだけではわからず，実際にやってみて初めてわかることが多い。

始める前から，うまくできるかどうかばかりを気にしていると，最初の一歩がなかなか踏み出せなくなる。だが，やってみた結果が思いどおりでなくても，それで時間が無駄になるわけではない。(2)うまくいかなかった経験でさえ，次に何を選ぶべきかを決める助けとなる大切な手がかりになりうる。

もちろん，何でも手当たり次第に試せばよいというわけではないし，一度始めたことをすぐに投げ出してよいわけでもない。(3)いちばん大切なのは，若いうちに，失敗を恐れることなく挑戦できる機会をたくさん持つことである。

問 1　下線部(1)を英文にせよ。

問 2　下線部(2)を下のような英文で表すとき，(A)〜(J)から8つを選んで正しく並べ，空所(①)(②)(③)にくるものの記号を書け。各選択肢は一度ずつ用いること。

Even experiences in which things did not go well (　　) (①) (　　) (　　) (②) (　　) (③) (　　) decide what to choose next.

(A) as	(B) clues	(C) can	(D) help	(E) important
(F) serve	(G) that	(H) us	(I) helps	(J) for

問 3　下線部(3)を下のような英文で表すとき，(A)〜(J)から8つを選んで正しく並べ，空所(①)(②)(③)にくるものの記号を書け。各選択肢は一度ずつ用いること。

What matters most is (①) (　　) (　　) (②) (　　) (　　) (③) (　　) without being afraid of failure while we are still young.

(A) to	(B) challenges	(C) having	(D) much	(E) on
(F) opportunities	(G) have	(H) plenty	(I) take	(J) of

解答用紙　予想問題 第2回

受験番号・氏名欄は省略。記号は (A) のように書く。

I

問 1	
問 2	
問 3	［　　］
問 4	（あ）［　　］　（い）［　　］　（う）［　　］
問 5	［　　］［　　］
問 6	3番目［　　］　5番目［　　］　8番目［　　］
問 7	［　　］［　　］

II

問 1	
問 2	3番目［　　］　6番目［　　］　9番目［　　］
問 3	
問 4	［　　］
問 5	［　　］［　　］
問 6	(a)［　　］　(b)［　　］　(c)［　　］　(d)［　　］

解答用紙（III・IV）

III

1) (1) [　　] (2) [　　] (3) [　　] (4) [　　]

III 2)（60〜80語）

20語

40語

60語

80語

IV

問 1

問 2 ① [　　] ② [　　] ③ [　　]

問 3 ① [　　] ② [　　] ③ [　　]

奥付

予想問題 第2回　英語　問題

対象：東北大学 前期日程 英語（全学部共通）の受験準備

作成：学習アプリ マナトビ 編集部（2026年10月）

作成方法：2024〜2026年度の出題形式・語数・難易度を分析し，英文・日本文・設問をすべて新たに書き下ろした。

> **東北大学の過去問・公式問題ではありません。予想問題であり，大学とは関係がありません。**

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